

PROJECT CONCEPT NOTE

Development of a Catholic Church Member Information and Management System

Project Focus	Digital management of Catholic Church member and community information
Organizational Structure	Diocese → Deanery → Parish → Zone → Small Christian Community → Family → Church Member
Date	September 2026

1. Background and Rationale

The Catholic Church serves its members through an organized community structure extending from the Diocese and Deanery to the Parish, Zone, Small Christian Community, Family, and individual Church members. Effective pastoral and administrative activities require reliable information about members, their families, Church associations, and responsibilities.

The proposed project will provide a centralized digital system for recording and managing Church member information within this structure. It will make member information easier to maintain, retrieve, update, and report while supporting appropriate access by authorized Church personnel.

2. Project Objectives

General Objective

To analyze, design, and develop a centralized digital system for capturing, organizing, and managing Catholic Church member information across the Church's organizational structure.

Specific Objectives

- To digitize and organize Church member registration and membership information.
- To maintain accurate records of Families, Small Christian Communities, Zones, Parishes, Deaneries, and Dioceses.
- To record member personal, contact, residence, baptism, identification, and Church affiliation information.
- To manage Church associations and leadership positions through flexible and maintainable records.
- To provide secure searching, updating, filtering, and reporting of authorized information.
- To support future expansion without redesigning the core system structure.

3. Proposed System

The system will provide a structured digital register of Church members and the communities to which they belong. Its core hierarchy will follow Diocese → Deanery → Parish → Zone → Small Christian Community → Family → Church Member. Each member record will be associated with the appropriate Family and Church organizational units.

The system will also maintain separate records for Church associations and leadership positions. Initially identified associations include UWAKA, WAWAKA, TCMS, and UKWAKATA. Leadership positions may include Priest, Deacon, Catechist, Community Elder, Chairperson of a Church Association, and other approved positions.

4. Project Scope

- Management of Diocese, Deanery, Parish, Zone, Small Christian Community, and Family records.
- Registration and maintenance of Church member profiles.
- Capture of first name, middle name, and last name.
- Capture of date of birth and marital status, including Single or Married.
- Capture of contact information, including phone number and email address.
- Capture of residence information, including house number, street, ward, district, and region.
- Recording of baptism status, including baptized or not baptized.
- Recording of the member identification number, including the offering number or digital offering number.
- Management of Church associations and leadership positions as separate records.
- Search, filtering, updating, and authorized reporting of member information.

5. Key System Requirements

- A centralized database for Church organizational and member information.
- Authentication and role-based access control for authorized users.
- Validation and uniqueness controls for important member identifiers.
- Ability to update member information while retaining appropriate change history.
- Flexible management of Church associations and leadership positions.
- Protection of personal information and regular data backup.
- Reports that can be filtered according to relevant Church organizational units.

6. Expected Outcomes

- A functioning digital Church member information management system.
- An organized and searchable database of Church members and Families.
- A clear digital representation of the Church organizational hierarchy.
- Improved accuracy, accessibility, and consistency of member records.
- Improved management of Church associations and leadership responsibilities.

- Reliable information for authorized administrative and pastoral reporting.

7. Target Users and Beneficiaries

- Authorized Church administrators and officials at relevant organizational levels.
- Parish, Zone, and Small Christian Community leaders responsible for member information.
- Church personnel responsible for Family and member records.
- Church members, indirectly, through improved administration and service delivery.

8. Implementation Approach

The project will proceed through requirements analysis, system design, database design, development, testing, deployment, and documentation. Detailed user roles, permissions, business rules, data relationships, and reporting requirements will be confirmed during requirements analysis before development begins.

9. Security, Privacy and Sustainability

Because the system will handle personal information, it will apply controlled access, authentication, role-based permissions, input validation, secure data handling, audit information for important changes, and regular backups. Sustainability will depend on user training, system maintenance, reliable infrastructure, backups, and periodic improvement based on operational needs.

10. Conclusion

The Catholic Church Member Information and Management System will provide a structured foundation for managing Church membership information from the Diocese level down to Families and individual Church members. By combining organizational, personal, family, association, and leadership information in one system, the project is expected to improve the efficiency, reliability, and accessibility of Church administration while providing a scalable foundation for future functions.